



**2026 HUSKY MARCHING BAND
VISUAL PROGRAM STANDARDS**

STATION 1

STATION 1: POSTURE/ATTENTION

Teaching Exercises:

- Teach Posture/Attention and commands that go with.
- Build up from the feet, to knees, hips, core, shoulders, arms, then head.
 - When you add a new component, review the ones previously taught before you keep adding.
- Shoulders and arms are positioned without tension, as they would naturally fall when standing.

NOTE: Instruments will be added in sections. All members will learn the same fundamentals, and alter as needed.

Test:

- Call band to attention (Band-(2-3-4)-Band-Ten-HUT-(4)) (Vocalize DAWGS on 1)
- Call to horns up (Band-(2-3-4)-Band-Horns-Up) (Vocalize BARK on 4)
- On a countoff, move up to full flare in one count. On a separate countoff, return to level in one count.
- Call to horns down (Band-(2-3-4)-Band-Horns-Down) (no vocals, move on 4)

STATION 1: RUBRIC

Category	Element	Novice	Developing	Proficient	Mastery
Stationary Positions and Alignment	Feet	Heels not touching, toes not close to 60 degrees	Heels together, toes apart (angle almost 60 degrees, and/or close to centered)	Heels together, toes apart at 60 degrees	"Proficient" with intensity in eyes and exhibiting comfortable control of the body
	Knees	Bent / Overly Locked	Straight with inconsistency	Straight not locked	"Proficient" with intensity in eyes and exhibiting comfortable control of the body
	Hips	Misaligned forward or backward	Generally aligned, with some tendency to forward or backward	In Alignment	"Proficient" with intensity in eyes and exhibiting comfortable control of the body
	Shoulders	Slumped or Pulled Back	Slight Tension (Raised?)	Down and Relaxed	"Proficient" with intensity in eyes and exhibiting comfortable control of the body
	Head	Craned Forward / Pulled Back /Chin Tucked	Slightly forward or back / Chin not consistently 10 degrees above parallel	Balanced on the A/O Joint, Chin is 10 degrees above parallel	"Proficient" with intensity in eyes and exhibiting comfortable control of the body
	Instrument	Held Incorrectly / Improper angles	Inconsistent Hand Placement / Fidgeting	Held Correctly and Still	"Proficient" with intensity in eyes and exhibiting comfortable control of the body
	Body Movement	Consistent twitching, fidgeting, and erroneous body movement	Small extra body movements	No erroneous body movement	"Proficient" with intensity in eyes and exhibiting comfortable control of the body

Horn Motion - Up, Down, Flares	Horn Movement	Slow and Uncontrolled	Anticipated / Late to finish	Movement happens in time	Crisp movement in time
	Movement After	Large movements and adjustments are required to correct the horn position after movement.	Slight motion before or after horn movement	Little to no movement in the horn before or after the move	"Locks" into place after arrival
	Instrument Hold	Held Incorrectly / Improper angles	Inconsistent Hand Placement / Fidgeting	Held Correctly and Still. Controlled "by the count" movement if relevant.	Horn movement is smooth and isolated from body posture, having NO affect on the body whatsoever
	Flares	Affect posture significantly / Incorrect angles	Slight posture inconsistencies / Angles are close	Movement happens from arms and around the A/O joint / Angles are accurate	Movement is smooth and isolated from body posture, having NO affect on the body whatsoever

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STATION 2

STATION 2: MARK TIME

Teaching Exercises:

- We always start marching on the left foot.
- By The Numbers
 - *When teaching angles, toe point, and other details, use descriptions from the rubric for clarity*
 - Count one is heel lifted (practicing toe point and shifting weight out of the heels).
 - Count two is full chair step (practicing leg shape and angles)
 - Count three is toe back on the ground
 - Count four is heel back on the ground.
 - Count 5-8 is the same as 1-4, on the right leg.
 - Counts 4 and 5 are important to note to practice shifting weight evenly from side to side, without bobbing and swaying.
- When moving from By The Numbers to a normal mark time, remember to specify that we need to lift the left leg on count eight in order for it to hit the ground on count one. Vocal: '5,6,7, lift, one'
- Address when feet are in the 45, vs when they move to parallel.
- Keep weight shifted to the toes, and utilize your ankles as shock absorbers to limit swaying and bobbing.

Test:

- Horn at playing position
- MT 2 Series at Q=92 , Rest , MT 2 Series at Q=120

STATION 2: RUBRIC

Category	Element	Novice	Developing	Proficient	Mastery
Mark Time	Thigh	Thigh is less than 70 degrees in parallel with the ground.	Between 70 and 80 degrees relative to parallel with the ground consistently	Consistently at 90 degrees / Parallel to the ground (Varies by instrument - Tenor Sax and Sousaphone)	"Proficient" with comfortable control of the body and absolute accuracy of angles in body adjustments.
	Calf	Calf swings inconsistently during the move	Perpendicular to the ground during most of the motion, with some inconsistency	Perpendicular to the ground throughout motion	"Proficient" with comfortable control of the body and absolute accuracy of angles in body adjustments.
	Toe Flex	No control of the foot angle	Effort is put toward toe flex, but is inconsistent	Toe is controlled and controlled, roughly 160-180 degrees with the ground.	"Proficient" with comfortable control of the body and absolute accuracy of angles in body adjustments.
	Leg Motion	Leg consistently pushes out / tucks in resulting in "bicycling" motion	Motion is inconsistent, some "bicycling" of the leg throughout	Movement is smooth, direct, and clear - free of "bicycling"	"Proficient" with comfortable control of the body and absolute accuracy of angles in body adjustments.
	Foot Timing	Timing is consistently inaccurate / Changes throughout the move	Foot timing is accurate, but may happen in the toe/ball/heel inconsistently	Timing happens accurately with the ball of the foot. Contact points leave in Heel - Ball - Toe, and connect with Toe-Ball-Heel	"Proficient" with comfortable control of the body and absolute accuracy of angles in body adjustments.
	Lower Body Control	Foot angle throughout motion is inconsistent	Foot angle may shift throughout the move / Body-center dot may drift 2-5 inches from the start	Feet remain parallel to one another during movement, and body-center dot doesn't drift more than 1-2 inches.	"Proficient" with comfortable control of the body and absolute accuracy of angles in body adjustments.
	Halt	Halt places feet in a very incorrect position	Halt places feet in a turned out position, but not the correct angle/orientation	Close places feet in the correct turned out position	"Proficient" with comfortable control of the body and absolute accuracy of angles in body adjustments.
	Upper Body Control	Consistent Bounce / Side-to-Side motion	Inconsistent control of the upper body - noticeable bounce/side-to-side motion, but not all the time	Limited to no side-to-side rocking and bounce during motion.	"Proficient" with comfortable control of the body and absolute accuracy of angles in body adjustments.

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STATION 3

STATION 3: FORWARD MARCH

Teaching Exercises:

- Explain a forward march - Technique only. Step size will be assessed separately.
- Where spot 1 through 8 is located on the hashes (demonstrate visually on hashlines through halves)
- Your “dot” is the middle of your foot, not the toe or heel.
- Ab/Core control is essential to avoid bobbing and swaying and stop movement at the halt.
 - Upper body/lower body separation allows the lower body to move while the upper body stays stable
- Weight should land on balls of your feet (not the heel only) when landing. This is where energy stays! Think lifting your energy upwards, like a string pulling you up along your spine out the top of your head.
- Legs and weight should not “stomp” on the ground, but a fluid movement.
 - Thinking about using shins or ankles to step forwards rather than foot/knees.
- Push off of the standing leg rather than reaching forward with the stepping leg.
- We don’t look at the ground while marching (don’t worry, it shouldn’t move on you!) so keep eyes and head lifted.
- Talk through the mechanics of taking a first step
 - How does the weight shift? What muscles should be engaged where? What techniques can be used to keep swaying and bobbing to a minimum?
- Build one step, then two, then a full series.

Halting:

- ‘5,6,7, step and close’
- Keep energy lifted at the end, so you don’t fall forward
- Feet move from parallel back to the 45
- Engage core!

Vocalizations:

- A beginning of a FM sequence is vocalized with “ 5 6 7 ‘LIFT’”, then vocalize every four steps (“4” or “8”) and then first count of next series vocalize the series number
- The last four steps before the next instruction, vocalize the next instruction over the last 4 counts (e.g. MT), UNLESS it is a halt vocalize “5 6 7 step and close”

Test:

- Tempo: 92bpm
 - FM 2 Series @ 8:5 and Halt
- Tempo: 120 bpm
 - ADJ 12 Counts @ 6:5 and Halt

STATION 3: FORWARD MARCH

Category	Element	Novice	Developing	Proficient	Mastery
Forward Movement Technique	Initiation	Does not occur in time - too soon or late. Vocal is nonexistent, incorrect, or unclear.	Occurs close to count 4, but knee might not hit the apex of the lift on count 4. Vocal may be clear, but not loud and crisp.	Occurs on count 4. Knee hits the apex of the lift ON count 4. Vocal "LIFT" is forte, crisp, and clean.	"Proficient" with intensity in eyes and exhibiting comfortable control of the body
	Leg Lift	Leg lift is noticeably and consistently below 70 degrees with parallel.	Is close to 90 degrees, but noticeably dips below or goes too high throughout the move at several points.	90 degrees with consistency on each step	"Proficient" with intensity in eyes and exhibiting comfortable control of the body
	Foot Contact	No toe point present. Feet are often bent and flat footed upon contact/departure with the ground.	Toe point is present but inconsistent, and toe may not always be the contact point with the ground.	Toe is consistently pointed, and leaves the ground toe-last, and makes contact toe-first.	"Proficient" with intensity in eyes and exhibiting comfortable control of the body
	Pathway	Misses dot and deviates from straight-line path noticeably.	Pathway between dots may be slightly off or inconsistent.	Pathway between dots is direct and straight.	"Proficient" with intensity in eyes and exhibiting comfortable control of the body
	Halt	Halt is incorrect with several mistake (feet in incorrect position, lots of movement in posture, or legs don't lift fully on last steps).	Halt is correct with ONE minor mistake (feet in incorrect position, lots of movement in posture, or legs don't lift fully on last steps).	Feet turn out, posture is maintained, and legs lift fully on last steps.	"Proficient" with no erroneous movement after the halt
	Instrument	Held Incorrectly / Improper angles	Inconsistent Hand Placement / Fidgeting	Held Correctly and Still	"Proficient" with intensity in eyes and exhibiting comfortable control of the body
	Body Movement	Lots of bobbing / sway present	Body is mostly controlled, with some minor bobbing and left-right sway	Body seems to glide evenly across ground without bobbing or left-right sway.	"Proficient" with effortless control of the body - no erroneous movement noticable

Step Size	Consistency	"Dot" is not achieved, and step size is noticeably inconsistent	"Dot" is achieved within a margin of error of 5 inches, some shrinking or surging of step size is noticeable	All steps are of consistent step size, within a small margin of error.	Each step is perfectly equal in any given move.
	8-to-5	"Dot" and all checkpoints are noticeably inaccurate	"Dot" is close, and checkpoints are minimally incorrect	"Dot" is achieved with 50% and 25% checkpoints achieved within a small margin of error	"Dot" is achieved with absolute accuracy, while hitting all 50% and 25% checkpoints at the appropriate locations
	6-to-5	"Dot" and all checkpoints are noticeably inaccurate	"Dot" is close, and checkpoints are minimally incorrect	"Dot" is achieved with 50% and 25% checkpoints achieved within a small margin of error	"Dot" is achieved with absolute accuracy, while hitting all 50% and 25% checkpoints at the appropriate locations

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STATION 4

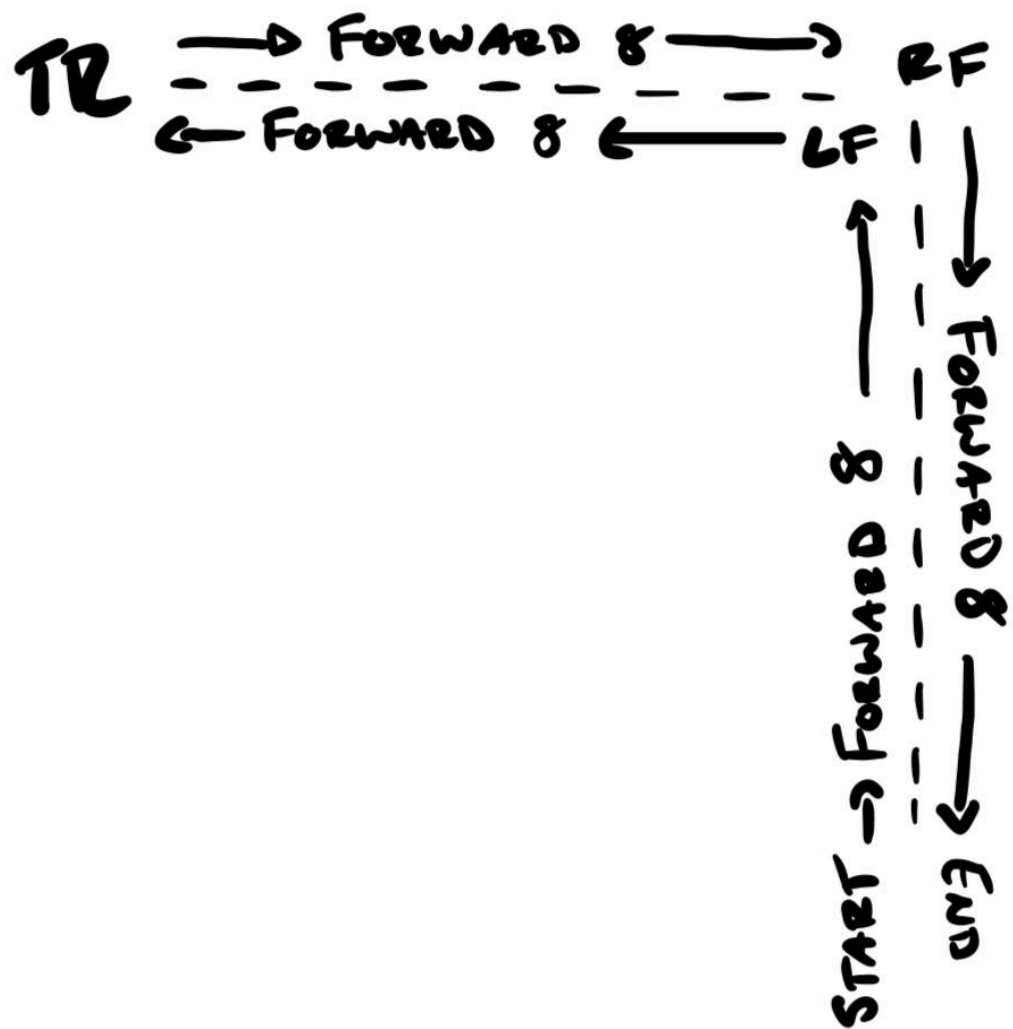
STATION 4: Direction Changes

Teaching Points

- Maintain 90 degree chair step before and after while pivoting on the ball of your foot
 - Full length step afterward
 - Avoid raising up on toes or sinking into the next step
 - Every flank (unless specified) is on the right foot
 - Under or overstep to keep center of body over dot
 - Prep step for the right flank, normal step for the left
- Vocalizations encouraged
- Horn flash (bell front brass)
 - Horn goes up and over (full flare on flank, vertical on TR), snappy
 - Valved brass: horn beats body around (very snappy)
- Turn Mechanics:
 - When placing the foot, split the difference between the direction you are coming from, and the direction you are going, to allow for a snappy turn with the least amount of strain on the knee joint. (e.g. if you are turning 90 degrees to the left, place your right foot at 45 degrees to the left)
 - Pivot on the ball of the foot (never flat footed)

Test: Marching L

- Tempo: 120 bpm
- Call band to attention
- Horn at playing position
- Forward 8 -> Left Flank -> Forward 8 -> TR -> Forward 8 -> Right flank -> Forward 8 -> Halt
 - Start on the yard line, left flank on hashes.
- Bump to halt



STATION 4: DIRECTION CHANGES

Category	Element	Novice	Developing	Proficient	Mastery
To the Rear (T.R.)	Dot Accuracy	Body is not close to the dot during the TR, creating imbalance during/after the turn	Body is mostly over the dot during the TR.	Body is centered over the dot during the TR.	"Proficiency" with intensity and comfortable body control.
	Step Size +1	Step sizes are not consistent.	Steps are consistent except those leading up to or the +1 after the TR (too large or too small)	All steps are consistent. +1 out of the TR is a full sized step.	"Proficiency" with intensity and comfortable body control.
	Turn	Pivot mechanics are incorrect, not happening on the ball of the foot, or not getting close to 180 degrees.	Body may pivot on the wrong part of the foot, causing the TR to not be 180 degrees.	Body pivots on the ball of the foot, and achieves a full 180 degree turn.	Turn is graceful, controlled, and accurate.
	Timing	Movement and foot placement are out of time.	Movement is in time, but timing of the +1 may be off in the foot / timed with the incorrect part of the foot.	Movement is in time, timed with the ball of the foot.	"Proficiency" with intensity and comfortable body control.
	Movement	Movement is uncontrolled during/after the TR, and height changes dramatically during the turn.	Some erroneous movement after the turn, some changes in levels during the TR.	No erroneous movement after the turn, and body stays relatively level during the TR	Optimal body control during the TR.

Left / Right Flank	Dot Accuracy	Body is not close to the dot during the flank, creating imbalance during/after the turn	Body is mostly over the dot during the flank.	Body is centered over the dot during the flank.	"Proficiency" with intensity and comfortable body control.
	Step Size +1	Step sizes are not consistent.	Steps are consistent except those leading up to or the +1 after the flank (too large or too small)	All steps are consistent. +1 out of the flank is a full sized step.	"Proficiency" with intensity and comfortable body control.
	Turn	Right foot pivots during the flank, turn is not 90 degrees.	Right foot doesn't "cheat" enough, and turn is not quite 90, or is close but displays discomfort in the flank turn.	Right foot accurately "cheats" and foot remains planted, turn is executed at a proper 90 degrees.	"Proficient" with intensity in eyes and exhibiting comfortable control of the body
	Timing	Movement and foot placement are out of time.	Movement is in time, but timing of the +1 may be off in the foot / timed with the incorrect part of the foot.	Movement is in time, timed with the ball of the foot.	"Proficiency" with intensity and comfortable body control.
	Movement	Movement is uncontrolled during/after the flank, and height changes dramatically during the turn.	Some erroneous movement after the turn, some changes in levels during the flank.	No erroneous movement after the turn, and body stays relatively level during the flank.	Optimal body control during the flank.
Horn Flash	Body Movement	Movement of upper body is uncontrolled and not in time.	Movement of upper body is slightly sluggish - in time but not snappy.	Movement is snappy and controlled.	Movement is crisp, controlled, and exhibits the highest level of body control and comfort in motion.
	Horn Movement	BFB: No horn flash, or incorrect horn flash. WW: Lots of horn movement.	BFB: Horn flash may not reach appropriate level, or dips noticeably below parallel. WW: Noticeable horn movement.	BFB: Horn Flash reaches full flare on flank, and vertical on TR's. Does not dip below parallel. WW: No change in horn level, perfectly controlled.	"Proficient" and complete stability (visual "silence") after the move.

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STATION 5

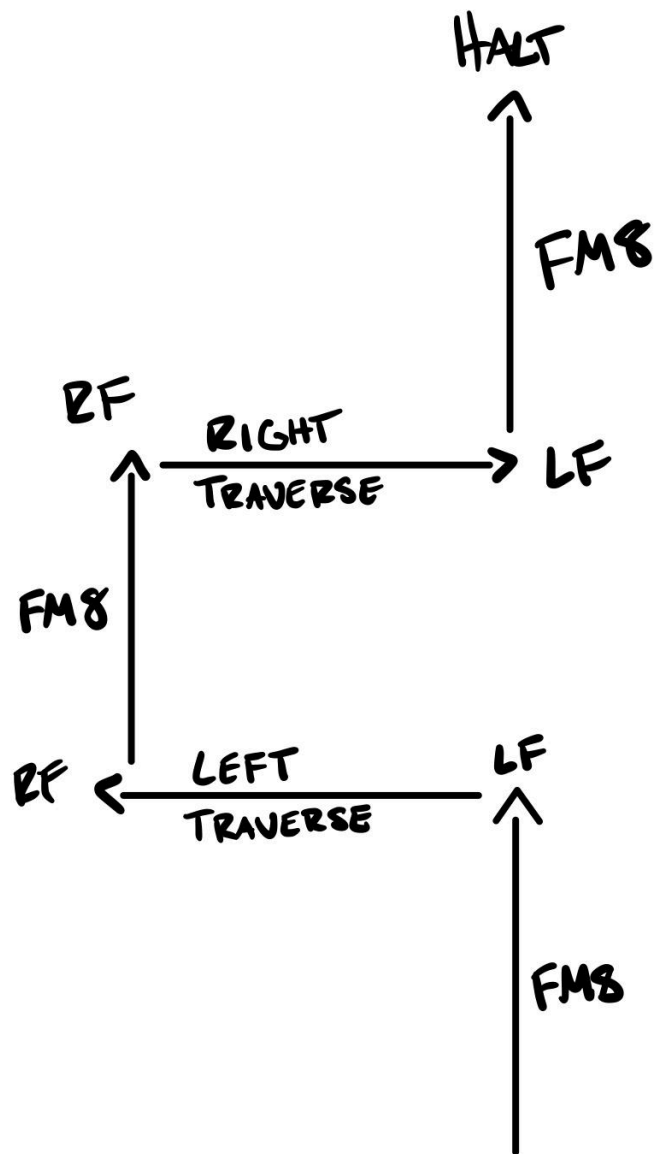
STATION 5: Traverse

Teaching Points:

- Walk through parts of the test slowly to practice
- Creating lower and upper body separation
 - Imagine they are two separate parts
 - Corkscrew Drill: start at attention facing forward, take 4 counts to rotate hips and upper body to the left, locking hips in on beat 2 and shoulders on beat 4, then rotate back to center. Repeat on the other side.
 - Build posture: Start stationary - rotate upper body 45°, freeze hips at 45°, continue shoulders to full 90°
 - Lower body stays stationary while upper body rotates independently
- Take a big first step into the first step of the slide, as it tends to be small because of the twisting motion to get your knee over to the correct spot
- How to not sway away from pathway of travel:
 - Backwards traverse: overcompensate forward, as we tend to drift backwards
 - Forward traverse: overcompensate backward, as we tend to drift forward
- Drill for practicing: in 4 beats, rotate upper body into left slide, then march forward 8 counts in a left traverse 8 to 5, halt 8 rotating upper fully to the right, passing the middle on beat 4, then march forward 8 in a right traverse 8 to 5.

Test: Box Drill

- Tempo: 120
- Call band to attention
- Horn at playing position
- Run through the box drill at an 8-5
 - FM 8, LF
 - Left Traverse 8, RF
 - FM 8, RF
 - Right Traverse 8, LF
 - FM 8
 - Half



STATION 5: TRAVERSING

Category	Element	Novice	Developing	Proficient	Mastery
Upper Body	Shoulder Direction	Shoulders not close to 90 degrees with front.	Shoulders tensed and slightly at an angle with the front consistently.	Shoulders parallel to the "front" for the duration with minimal movement.	"Proficient" and movement is controlled and confident.
	Torso Twist	Stomach angle rarely between 35°-55° to direction of travel. Posture greatly affected by motion.	Stomach angle inconsistent with shoulders, often outside 35°-55° to direction of travel. Posture is affected by traverse.	Stomach between 35°-55° to direction of travel. Posture remains correct.	Stomach is almost exactly 45° to direction of travel. Posture is not discernable from standard position of attention.
	Movement	Lots of erroneous body movement.	Some erroneous body movement.	Limited to no bouncing / erroneous body movement	Smooth body motion - if you covered up the legs, you wouldn't know they're facing a different direction. Upper body "glides".
Horn Flash	Momentum Shift	Direction changes are slow and lack coordination.	Direction changes may be slow or slightly rounded.	Direction changes are snappy and accurate.	"Proficient" and movement is controlled and confident.
	Trunk Twist	Knees and toes do not align with direction of travel.	Knees and toes are at a slight angle to direction of travel, creating a slight "side step" effect	Knees and toes mostly face the direction of travel, independent of the upper body	Knees and toes perfectly and consistently align with direction of travel.
	FM Technique	Chair step technique is lacking.	Knees may inconsistently be at 90° or less throughout, and leg lift is noticeably affected by the traverse	Knees are near a 90° leg lift throughout with minimal variation during traverse	Knees are consistently at 90° chair step throughout.
	Step Size	Step size is inconsistent.	Step size is consistent in each leg of the exercise, but is affected during direction changes.	Step size is consistent, especially through direction changes	Step size is consistent and controlled through entire exercise.
	Pathway	Significant drifting from the pathway throughout.	Occasional, noticable drifting, corrected within 3-4 steps into the series	Occasional, but minimal, drifting, fixed within 1-2 steps into the series.	No drifting from the pathway throughout.

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STATION 6

STATION 6: BACKWARD MARCHING

Teaching Points:

- By the numbers teaching
 - 1 - Toe pointed with heel off the ground
 - 2 - Move thigh parallel to ground, bent knee with ankle in line with the standing knee
 - 3 - Move leg back with toe on ground, 22.5" step, leg is straight
 - 4 - Flatten foot and shift weight, as next foot lifts to step 2 position
 - 5 - Right foot repeats motion
- Toe point in line with calf
- Thigh parallel to the ground
- Body is upright
- Ankle of Foot by the standing leg's knee
- At no point when backwards marching should you be in a traditional chair step (i.e., toe point, at a full 90 at the knee)
- For step size: have one person march forward beside the people marching backwards to check step size

Test:

- Tempo: 120 bpm
- Call band to attention
- Horn at playing position
- Backwards march 1 series
- MT 1 series
- Backwards march 2 series
- Halt

STATION 6- BACKWARD MARCHING

Category	Element	Novice	Developing	Proficient	Mastery
Backward Movement Technique	Initiation	Does not occur in time - too soon or late. Vocal is nonexistent, incorrect, or unclear.	Occurs close to count 4, but knee might not hit the apex of the lift on count 4. Vocal may be clear, but not loud and crisp.	Occurs on count 4. Knee hits the apex of the lift ON count 4. Vocal "LIFT" is forte, crisp, and clean.	"Proficient" with intensity in eyes and exhibiting comfortable control of the body
	Leg Lift	Leg lift is noticeably and consistently below 70 degrees with parallel.	Is close to 90 degrees, but noticeably dips below or goes too high throughout the move at several points.	90 degrees with consistency on each step	"Proficient" with intensity in eyes and exhibiting comfortable control of the body
	Foot Contact	No toe point present. Feet are often bent and flat footed upon contact/departure with the ground.	Toe point is present but inconsistent, and toe may not always be the contact point with the ground.	Toe is consistently pointed, and leaves the ground toe-last, and makes contact toe-first.	"Proficient" with intensity in eyes and exhibiting comfortable control of the body
	Pathway	Misses dot and deviates from straight-line path noticeably.	Pathway between dots may be slightly off or inconsistent.	Pathway between dots is direct and straight.	"Proficient" with intensity in eyes and exhibiting comfortable control of the body
	Halt	Halt is incorrect with several mistake (feet in incorrect position, lots of movement in posture, or legs don't lift fully on last steps).	Halt is correct with ONE minor mistake (feet in incorrect position, lots of movement in posture, or legs don't lift fully on last steps).	Feet turn out, posture is maintained, and legs lift fully on last steps.	"Proficient" with no erroneous movement after the halt
	Instrument	Held Incorrectly / Improper angles	Inconsistent Hand Placement / Fidgeting	Held Correctly and Still	"Proficient" with intensity in eyes and exhibiting comfortable control of the body
	Body Movement	Lots of bobbing / sway present	Body is mostly controlled, with some minor bobbing and left-right sway	Body seems to glide evenly across ground without bobbing or left-right sway.	"Proficient" with effortless control of the body - no erroneous movement noticeable

Step Size	Consistency	"Dot" is not achieved, and step size is noticeably inconsistent	"Dot" is achieved within a margin of error of 5 inches, some shrinking or surging of step size is noticeable	All steps are of consistent step size, within a small margin of error.	Each step is perfectly equal in any given move.
	8-to-5	"Dot" and all checkpoints are noticeably inaccurate	"Dot" is close, and checkpoints are minimally incorrect	"Dot" is achieved with 50% and 25% checkpoints achieved within a small margin of error	"Dot" is achieved with absolute accuracy, while hitting all 50% and 25% checkpoints at the appropriate locations

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INSTRUMENT CARRY SPECIFICS

INSTRUMENT SPECIFICS:

INSTRUMENT CARRY	<i>Developing (1)</i>	<i>Proficient (2)</i>	<i>Mastery (3)</i>
Piccolo	Instrument carry - Right fist is clenched; right fist placed at base of right ribcage; left hand holding piccolo (keys facing forward) and forearm perpendicular to your body and parallel to the ground. Horns Up - Piccolo is not parallel to the ground, bent or at an angle, or not at mouth. - Movement is slow - Right arm is tucked in too far to the body	Instrument carry - Fist not totally clenched; right fist placement slightly off base of right ribcage; left forearm and/or left hand holding piccolo deviates slightly from perpendicular to body and parallel to ground. Horns Up - Piccolo is parallel to the ground (not bent or at an angle) and is at mouth. - Movement is swift - Right arm is not tucked into the side.	Instrument carry - Shoulders relaxed, down, and of even height. - Left hand grasping between 3 and 4 o'clock on the Fists not clenched; right fist missing base of right ribcage; left forearm and/or hand holding piccolo deviates extremely from perpendicular to body and parallel to ground. Horns Up - Piccolo is parallel to the ground (not bent or at an angle) and is at mouth - Movement is swift and precise - Right arm is not tucked into the side.
Clarinet	Instrument carry: - Clarinet is tucked in or too far out - Lyre is not between 3rd and 4th fingers - Left wrist is strained in one direction making clarinet angled too far out	Instrument carry: - Clarinet is straight up and down, perpendicular to the ground - Lyre is between left hand's 3rd and 4th fingers and left hand is holding clarinet	Everything in the proficient category is maintained at a high level with comfortable and snappy control of the instrument, with a clarinet at playing

	Horns up: • Clarinet comes up too slowly and is not at 45° • Left hand has too much extra and slow movement into place • Clarinet is too far away from face Full flare: • Clarinet is not parallel to the ground Horn Flash - TR/Flank: • Erroneous horn movement	• Left forearm parallel to the ground • Left wrist is straight and relaxed, not obviously bent in any one direction Horns up: • The one count move of a bark up brings the instrument up • The clarinet is at a 40-50 degree angle from the body • The right hand moves to meet the instrument (below the lyre onto the keys), and the mouthpiece moves to within about 1 inch of the face • After the instrument is barked up, the left hand moves from holding the lyre onto the keys, without wrist movement Full Flare: • Clarinet is parallel to the ground (or to the best of the players ability without sacrificing rest of posture) Horn Flash - TR/Flank: • No horn movement outside of the playing position angle	position 45 degrees from the body. • Movement of the left hand and mouthpiece between horns up and full flare is sneaky!
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Alto Sax	Attention • Saxophone tube is angled >10° above or below parallel to the ground • Saxophone is touching the chest or held >10 cm (≈4 in) away from the chest • Right wrist is curved more than 15° or visibly tensed • Left wrist shows extreme tension • Horn is rotated >10° inward or outward relative to the torso Horns Up • Saxophone body is ≥5° away from perpendicular to the ground • Elbows are tensed and positioned <7 cm or >13 cm (fist ≈10 cm) from the body Full Flare • Saxophone bell is angled <40° or >50° above horns-up position Neck strap has significant slack	Attention • Saxophone tube is angled within ±10° of parallel to the ground • Saxophone is held 7–13 cm (≈fist ±3 cm) from the chest • Right wrist is curved up to 15° or mildly tensed • Left wrist shows noticeable tension • Horn is rotated within ±10° of parallel to the torso Horns Up • Saxophone body is within ±5° of perpendicular to the ground • Elbows are tensed and positioned 7–13 cm (≈fist ±3 cm) from the body Full Flare • Saxophone bell is angled 40–50° above horns-up Neck strap is almost taut	Attention • Saxophone tube is parallel (±2°) to the ground • Saxophone is held 10 cm (≈fist width) from chest • Right wrist is flat (0–5° bend) and relaxed • Left wrist is relaxed • Horn is parallel (±2°) to the torso Horns Up • Saxophone body is perpendicular (±2°) to the ground • Elbows are relaxed and 10 cm (≈fist width) from the body Full Flare • Saxophone bell is exactly 45° (±2°) above horns-up Neck strap is taut
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Tenor Sax	Instrument Carry (Developing) • Saxophone is carried at higher or lower than 45 degrees • Saxophone is touching the chest, or is more than a fist's width away from the chest Horns up: • Saxophone is not perpendicular to the ground • Hands are not in playing position, or additional movement is needed to place them there Full flare: • Saxophone is higher or lower than 45 degrees above horns up position Horn Flash: • Excessive horn movement	Instrument Carry (Proficient) Attention: • Saxophone is carried slightly below or above 45 degrees • Saxophone is held about a fist's width away from the chest Horns up: • Saxophone body is nearly perpendicular to the ground • Hands are immediately in playing position with little to no movement Full flare: • Saxophone is angled at about 45 degrees above horns up position Horn flash: • Saxophone remains in playing position and little to no excessive movement	Instrument Carry (Mastery) Attention: • Saxophone is carried at 45 degrees consistently • Saxophone is held a fist's width away from the chest Horns up: • Saxophone body is exactly perpendicular to the ground • Hands are immediately in playing position, very minimal movement Full flare: • Saxophone is angled at 45 degrees above horns up position Horn flash: • Saxophone remains in playing position and no excessive movement
Trumpet	Instrument Carry Attention: • Trumpet in left hand is lax, moving too much, twisted/not perpendicular to the ground, wrist bent, etc Horns up: • Trumpet held below parallel • Wrists bent • Arms too tight to body or elbows extended • Horn twisted • Embouchure: chin too far	Instrument Carry • Attention: Trumpet in left hand in attention position; valves forward and horn perpendicular to the ground with wrist as straight as possible • Horns up: Trumpet held parallel-5* above parallel • Wrists straight • Arms held naturally in an approximately equilateral triangle • Embouchure at appropriate	Instrument Carry • Attention: Everything in the proficiency category without tension. • Horns up: Trumpet held 5-10* above parallel • Wrists straight and relaxed • Arms held naturally in an equilateral triangle • Embouchure at appropriate angle to horn (chin 10* above parallel) • Horns down: horn moves very

	up/down Horns down: • horn moves too far off face, slowly, indirectly • too much wiggling at end of movement, lack of visual silence Horn Flash/Flanks • horn doesn't fully go to/above full flare when changing direction, slow movement, without purpose/uneven travel velocity • excessive shoulder movement, movement from elbows	angle to horn • Horns down: horn moves off face slightly and down quickly Horn Flash/Flanks: • Horn rises to a full flare on flanks OR nearly vertical on TRs • Horn flash is fast, but may arrive at the same time as the body • Flash occurs from arms and head, with minor shoulder movement	slightly off face and down snappily Horn Flash • Horn rises to a full flare on flanks and vertical on TRs • Horn flash incredibly snappy and beats body around • Flash occurs from arms and head
Mellophone	Instrument Carry • Attention: Horn in left hand is lax, moving too much, twisted/not perpendicular to the ground, wrist bent, etc Horns up: • Horn held below parallel • Wrists bent • Arms too tight to body or elbows extended • Horn twisted • Embouchure: chin too far up/down Horns down: • horn moves too far off face, slowly, indirectly Horn Flash/Flanks • Horn does not rise to full flare on flanks or vertical on TRs • Horn flash is slow and not controlled • Shoulder movement is significant	Instrument Carry • Attention: Horn in left hand in attention position; valves forward and horn perpendicular to the ground with wrist as straight as possible Horns up: • Horn held within 5 degrees of parallel • Wrists straight • Arms held naturally in an approximately equilateral triangle Horns down: • Embouchure at appropriate angle to horn Horns down: • horn moves off face slightly and down quickly Horn Flash/Flanks: • Horn rises to a full flare on flanks OR nearly vertical on TRs	Instrument Carry • Attention: Everything in proficiency category with no tension Horns up: • Horn held perfectly parallel • Wrists straight and relaxed • Arms held naturally in an equilateral triangle • Embouchure at appropriate angle to horn Horns down: • horn moves very slightly off face and down snappily Horn Flash • Horn rises to a full flare on flanks and vertical on TRs • Horn flash incredibly snappy and beats body around • Flash occurs from arms and head

		• Horn flash is fast, but may arrive at the same time as the body • Flash occurs from arms and head, with minor shoulder movement	
Trombone	Instrument Carry • Trombone held too low with left hand • Slide not collinear with forearm • Right hand in incorrect position • Horn swaying more than ~1deg with no correction • Instrument not vertically aligned Horn Flash/Flanks: • Slide is not at full flare, OR is not up to 150 deg minimum on TR • Turn is not snappy and/or horn lags behind body • Flash occurring from back rather than head pivot point	Instrument Carry • Trombone should be held in left hand, held in attention position • Face of the slide should be collinear with forearm • Right hand still placed in attention position • Horn exhibits no sway or minor sway that corrects itself (no more than ~1deg) • Bell and slide parallel and perpendicular to ground, respectively Horn Flash/Flanks: • Slide rises to a full flare on turn, OR at least 150 deg for TR's • Turn is snappy, and horn doesn't lag behind body • Flash occurs from head pivot point and arms, with minor movement in shoulders	Instrument Carry • Everything in proficiency category maintained • Form is identical to attention position without instruments • Horn exhibits absolutely no sway Horn Flash/Flanks: • Slide rises to a full flare on turn, OR at least 175 deg for TR's • Turn is exceptionally snappy, and horn is perfectly in time with body • Flash occurs from head pivot point and arms
Baritone	Instrument Carry: • Bell is not parallel with the ground and either tipped too far	Instrument Carry: • Bell is essentially parallel with the ground, within 5	Instrument Carry: • Bell is perfectly parallel with the ground

	- up or down - Valves are not straight up forward and the left hand is tilted - Grip is too loose and not safe enough to hold the horn with control Horn Flash/Flanks: - Flash doesn't go up to full flare through TR or flank - Turn is not snappy, delayed, and not in time with music	degrees of parallel - Valves are straight forward and perpendicular to the ground - Left hand grip is pretty tight and exhibits general control of the horn Horn Flash/Flanks: - Flash goes up to full flare through TR or flank - Turn is snappy and not late, but may be slightly delayed with the rest of body movement	- Valves are perfectly perpendicular to the ground - Left hand grip is tight and in control of the horn Horn Flash/Flanks: - Flash goes up to full flare through TR or flank - Turn is exceptionally snappy and horn is perfectly in time with body
Sousaphone	Posture & Carry - Bell protrudes at an angle beyond the left shoulder, or does not face straight ahead. Bell obscures one or both eyes, or leaves the entire face visible when viewed from the front. - Shoulders are tense and raised, or are of uneven height. - Left hand grasps body of sousaphone beyond 3 or 4 o'clock, or grasps an alternative place on the horn. - Right hand thumb is not in the thumb ring or fingers are not on the keys. - Right wrist is bent to the point that it carries tension or looks exceedingly awkward. - Right elbow floats away from the body of the horn, or presses	Posture & Carry - Bell sits vertically aligned with left shoulder and faces straight ahead. Should obscure a portion of the forehead but not the eyes when viewed from the front. - Shoulders carry tension, or are of uneven height. - Left hand grasps body of sousaphone between 3 and 4 o'clock, just above the white bra. - Right hand thumb is in the thumb ring and fingers on the keys. - Right wrist is bent to the point that it carries tension or looks exceedingly awkward. - Right elbow rests against	Posture & Carry - Bell sits vertically aligned with left shoulder and faces straight ahead. Should obscure a portion of the forehead but not the eyes when viewed from the front. - Shoulders are relaxed, down, and of even height - Left hand grasps body of sousaphone between 3 and 4 o'clock, just above the white bra. - Right hand thumb is in the thumb ring and fingers on the keys. - Right wrist is as straight as possible and without visible tension. - Right elbow rests against

	against the ribs with tension. Horn Down • Mouthpiece is more than 2 inches from the mouth, or neck cranes/retracts significantly from neutral position. Horn Up • Motion is slow or out of time • Neck must crane/retract significantly from neutral position to reach mouthpiece. Flare • Angle change driven entirely by horn lift or entirely by leaning at the hips. • Back is arched • Neck is craned or retracted • Position quivers, shakes, or cannot be maintained. • Standards of bell angle change and snappiness of motion are maintained just as any other instrument. Mark Time • Left thigh angle is less than 60 degrees or strikes the instrument. • Right thigh angle is less than 30 degrees or strikes instrument. • Pronounced horizontal sway or vertical bounce. • All standards of toe-point, calf-perpendicularity, and precision of motion are maintained just as any other instrument	the body of the horn, either inside or outside the loop. Horn Down • Mouthpiece reaches within 2 inches of the mouth with a slight craning of the neck or retracting of the chin. Horn Up • Motion is in time and preceded with a small downward prep to accentuate the movement. • Mouthpiece reaches the mouth with a slight craning of the neck or retracting of the chin. Flare • Angle change driven by a ratio other than 70/30 lifting instrument/bringing hips forward and shoulders back. • Back is straight, not arched • Neck may be slightly craned or retracted • Position is mostly solid, minimal quiver or shake • Standards of bell angle change and snappiness of motion are maintained just as any other instrument. Mark Time • Left thigh angle between 60 and 90 degrees. • Right thigh angle between	the body of the horn, either inside or outside the loop. Horn Down • Mouthpiece reaches within 2 inches of the mouth without craning the neck or retracting the chin. Horn Up • Motion is quick, controlled, and preceded with a small downward prep to accentuate the movement. • Mouthpiece reaches the mouth without craning the neck or retracting the chin. Flare • Angle change is 70% driven by instrument lift and head tilt and 30% driven by bringing hips forward and shoulders back. • Back is straight, not arched • Neck is not craned or retracted • Position is solid, no quiver or shake • Standards of bell angle change and snappiness of motion are maintained just as any other instrument. Mark Time • Left thigh reaches an 80
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		30 and 60 degrees. • Slight visible horizontal sway or vertical bounce. • All standards of toe-point, calf-perpendicularity, and precision of motion are maintained just as any other instrument	degree angle, or as near as possible without striking the instrument. • Right thigh reaches an 45 degree angle, or as near as possible without striking the instrument. • No visible horizontal sway or vertical bounce. • All standards of toe-point, calf-perpendicularity, and precision of motion are maintained just as any other instrument
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